

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J T 8

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A 5

♣ 9 6 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K Q J

♦ Q J T 9 7

♣ A T 4



♠ 4

♥ T 9 8 4

♦ 8 6 3 2

♣ K 8 7 2

♠ A 9 7 6 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 4

♣ Q J 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

Dbl

All Pass

3NT by North

With any other lead declarer will make the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠ 4.

If partner had not doubled the contract you would probably have started with the ♥ 10, or possibly the ♣ 2.

But partner DID double, and most good players play that doubling 3NT is lead-directing as follows: If you have bid a suit, lead it. If doubler has bid a suit, lead it. If neither of you has bid, lead dummy's first bid suit.

So lead a ♠, certainly not a lead you would have made without the double. Partner immediately establishes 4 ♠ winners and he has the ♦ A for an entry.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 8 6 4
 ♥ A J 6 5
 ♦ Q 7
 ♣ J 6 3

♠ 5 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 8 4 2

♣ A K Q 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 7

♥ K T 9 8

♦ A K 5

♣ T 9 2

♠ J T 9 3

♥ 4 2

♦ J T 9 6 3

♣ 8 5

West

North

East

South

2♣

Dbl

1NT

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Lead the ♣8.

If partner had not doubled West's Stayman 2♣ bid you would probably have started with one of your Jacks.

But partner **DID** double, and the double of a conventional bid clearly means that the doubler would like you to lead that suit.

So lead a ♣, and partner will take three ♣ tricks. With any other lead declarer would quickly discard a ♣ from dummy on a high ♦, easily making the contract.

Declarer may still make the contract if he guesses the ♥Q correctly, but maybe not.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 2
♥ Q J T 6
♦ T 7 6 2
♣ 7 3

♠ K J 5
♥ A 9 8 5 3
♦ K Q
♣ A Q 5



♠ T 8 6 4
♥ 7 2
♦ J 9 3
♣ J T 9 8

♠ A Q 3
♥ K 4
♦ A 8 5 4
♣ K 6 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♦ 2, or perhaps the ♠ 9. Admittedly the ♥ Q looks very tempting, but resist the temptation.

Since dummy bid ♥ s, don't help declarer by leading the suit. Declarer has 11 tricks, and will hope to pick up one more in ♣ s, but that won't happen.

But if you start with the ♥ Q, he will win with his ♥ K and can then establish an extra ♥ winner by leading through your ♥ J 10 into dummy's ♥ A 9.

With any lead other than a ♥ honor he cannot come to 12 tricks.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K J 9 6 3

♥ A 6

♦ K 9

♣ Q T 8 5

♠ A

♥ Q J T 3

♦ 8 7 5 3

♣ A 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q T 8 5

♥ K 5 4

♦ A T

♣ K J 9 6

♠ 7 4 2

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ Q J 6 4 2

♣ 3

West

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ X by West

♣ which he will again ruff.

North

Pass

Pass

Dbl

East

2 ♣

4 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Did you choose the ♥Q? I was afraid you would. That is wrong, but because this is the last Deal I'm going to give you another chance.

Look at the bidding carefully, then ask yourself why you doubled.

Now pick the opening lead that will set the contract, then

Lead the ♣A, then follow with a small ♣.

East/West apparently have 8 or more ♣s between them, which leaves partner with a singleton at most.

Partner will ruff the second ♣, and when you get into the lead with the Ace of trumps you will play a third

That's why you doubled.